

TYPES OF CONTACTS

There are many different types of contacts between mappable units (refer to geologic map and structure symbols). However, for this field course, three types of contacts will be used to express your level of confidence:

- Solid line = definite contact (you are sure you have located the contact within the line width on your map); sometimes you can show the dip direction and amount with an arrow, as below (intrusive igneous contacts can sometimes dip inwards):



Figure 1. Contact position known well (50 ft on a 1:24,000 map)

- Dashed contact = the contact is reasonably well located, but possibly not within a line width on the map

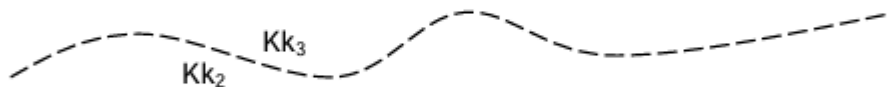


Figure 2. Contact known with less precision

- Dotted contact = concealed contact (i.e., beneath Quaternary alluvium)

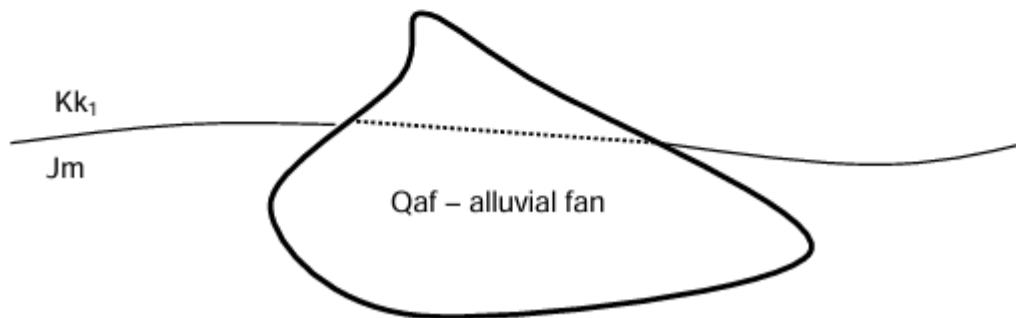


Figure 3. Contact concealed below a surficial unit.

COMMON SYMBOLS USED ON GEOLOGIC MAPS

	Strike and dip of bedding
	Overturned bedding
	Vertical bedding
	Horizontal bedding
	Crumpled bedding
	Trace of contact
	Less well-located contact
	Covered contact
	Fault contact with dip
	Sense of slip on strike-slip fault
	Sense of slip on dip-slip fault (D = down, U = up)
	Thrust fault, barbs on upper plate
	Bearing and plunge of fold axis or lineation
	Strike and dip of foliation, cleavage, or schistosity
	Vertical foliation, cleavage, or schistosity
	Strike and dip of joints or dikes
	Vertical joints or dikes
	Trace of axial surface or crest of anticline, with plunge
	Trace of axial surface or trough of syncline, with plunge
	Anticline with overturned limb
	Syncline with overturned limb
	Trace of axial surface with bearing and plunge of fold axis
	Overturned anticline with bearing and plunge of fold axis

Figure 4. Common symbols on a geologic map (from Rowland et al., 2007, appendix F)